



**M365 Adoption
RISK RESGISTER
Version 1.0**

Document Owner: ICT Risk Manager



Contents

M365 PLATFORM - PROJECT RISK REGISTER.....	iii
1. 0 OVERVIEW OF RISK MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK.....	iii
1.1 Introduction.....	iii
1.2 Risk Categories	iv
1.3 Risk Management Processes.....	iv
2.0 PROJECT RISK REGISTER:	1



M365 PLATFORM - PROJECT RISK REGISTER

This document serves as the formal mechanism for identifying, recording, monitoring and managing risks that may impact the successful implementation, adoption, and ongoing use of the Microsoft M365 (M365) platform within ICDFA.

Effective risk management is a critical component of project governance. It enables stakeholders to proactively identify potential threats, assess their impact, and implement appropriate controls or treatments to minimize disruption to project objectives, timelines, security posture and user adoption.

The purpose of this document is to:

- Identify potential project-related risks associated with the M365 platform.
- Provide a structural approach for assessing and prioritizing those risks
- Track risk ownership, treatment actions and status throughout the project lifecycle and post-implementation adoption phase.

For the purpose of this document, a risk is defined as:

Any uncertain or unexpected event or condition that if it occurs, could negatively affect delivery, security, compliance, usability, or adoption of the M365 platform.

The risk register supports informed decision-making, risk acceptance, and escalation in line with ICDFA's risk-based policy design philosophy and project governance framework.

1.0 OVERVIEW OF RISK MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

1.1 Introduction

Effective risk management is essential to the successful implementation and adoption of the Microsoft M365 (M365) Platform at the International Cybersecurity and Digital Forensics Academy (ICDFA). As a digital learning institution with a diverse student population, including minors, ICDFA must proactively identify and manage risk that could negatively impact academic delivery, data protection, regulatory compliance and user trust.

For the purpose of this risk register, risk is defined as the possibility that an event or action may occur that could adversely affect the M365 platform's implementation, operation, or adoption. Such impacts may include disruption to learning activities, compromise of sensitive data, non-compliance with regulatory obligations, or reduced confidence in the platform.

This risk management framework provides a structured approach for identifying, assessing, monitoring, and managing risks associated with the use of M365 in line with ICDFA's policy design principles and risk-based governance approach.



1.2 Risk Categories

The types and level of risks faced by ICDFA depend on factors such as academic model, distributed student population, reliance on cloud-based services, and regulatory obligations. For the purpose of the M365 platform risk register, the following risk categories are considered most relevant:

- 1. Strategic Risks**
Risks arising from poor alignment between M365 platform implementation and ICDFA's academic objectives, learning models, or long-term strategy.
- 2. Operational Risk**
Risk Resulting from inadequate processes, system failures, human error, or ineffective operational controls that may disrupt teaching, learning, or administration.
- 3. Information and Communication Technology Risk (ICT Risks)**
Risks related to system availability, security misconfigurations, identity and access management, data breaches, and limitations of the M365 licensing model.
- 4. Data Protection and Privacy Risk**
Risks associated with the exposure, misuse, or improper handling of personal data, academic records, and sensitive information, particularly involving minors.
- 5. Compliance Risk**
Risks arising from failure to comply with applicable laws, regulations, and internal policies, including data protection, academic integrity, and monitoring obligations.
- 6. Reputational Risk**
Risks that may damage ICDFA's reputation due to data breaches, misuse of M365 tools, policy violations, or perceived lack of governance.
- 7. Third-Party and Vendor Risk**
Risks introduced through reliance on Microsoft as a cloud service provider and other external vendors with access to ICDFA systems or data.

1.3 Risk Management Processes

ICDFA adopts a structured risk management process to ensure that risks related to the M365 platform are identified, assessed, and managed throughout the project lifecycle and during ongoing operations. The risk management process is designed to be proportionate to the size, complexity, and risk profile of the academy.

Responsibility for risk management is shared among relevant stakeholders, with oversight provided through defined governance and policy frameworks. Risks are documented in the M365 Project Risk Register and reviewed periodically to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness of controls.

The risk management process includes the following key activities:

1.3.1 Risk Identification

Risk Identification is an ongoing process aimed at recognizing current and emerging risks associated with the use of M365. Risks may arise from technology, people, process, data handling practices, or external factors. Each identified risk is documented clearly and consistently in the risk register.



1.3.2 Risk Assessment and Measurement

Once identified, risks are assessed based on their likelihood of occurrence and potential impact on ICDFA's academic operations, security, compliance, and reputation. This assessment supports prioritization and informs appropriate risk treatment decisions.

1.3.3 Risk Control and Treatment

Risk control involves selecting and implementing appropriate measures to manage identified risks. These may include risk avoidance, risk mitigation through technical or administrative controls, risk transfer, or risk acceptance where justified. Controls are aligned with ICDFA's policies and the capabilities of the M365 platform.

1.3.4 Risk Monitoring and Review

Risks and associated controls are continuously monitored to detect changes in risk exposure, effectiveness of controls, or emergence of new risks. The risk register is reviewed regularly to ensure it remains accurate and supports informed decision-making throughout the M365 platform lifecycle.



2.0 M365 PROJECT RISK REGISTER:

Risk ID	Risk Category	Risk Description	Affected M365 Service	Data Type Involved	Likelihood	Impact	Risk Rating	Key Controls	Risk Owner	Status
M365 R-1	ICT/Security	Unauthorized Access to student or staff accounts due to weak authentication or poor account lifecycle management	Entra ID, Outlook, Teams, OneDrive	Student PII, Academic Records, Session recordings, Learning resources	Medium	High	High	Identity and Access Management, Policy	ICT Admin	Open
M365 R-2	ICT/Security	Abuse or misuse of privileged administrator accounts leading to critical system or data compromise	M365 Admin Center, Entra ID	All M365 Data	Low	Very High	High	Privileged Access Management Policy, Least Privilege, JIT Access, Monitoring	ICT Admin	Open
M365 R-3	Operational / Compliance	Misuse of M365 tools by students or staff resulting in academic	Teams, Outlook, Office Online	Academic Content, Communication	Medium	Medium	Medium	Acceptable Use Policy	Faculty/Admin	Open



		integrity violations or misuse of institutional resources								
M365-R4	ICT/Security	Phishing or social engineering attacks leading to credential theft or data leakage	Outlook, Teams	Credentials Student PII	High	High	High	Email & Communication security Policy	ICT Admin	Open
M365-R5	Privacy/Compliance	Accidental exposure or oversharing of sensitive student data, including minor's information	OneDrive, Teams	Student PII, Grades, Recordings	Medium	High	High	Data Protection, Retention & Classification Policy	Compliance Officer	Open
M365-R6	ICT/Endpoint	Compromised personal or shared devices accessing M365 leading to session hijacking or data leakage	All M365 Services	Credentials, Academic data	Medium	Medium	Medium	Device & Endpoint security Policy	ICT Admin	Open



M365-R7	ICT/ Detection	Security incidents go undetected or are responded to late due to insufficient logging or monitoring	All M365 services	Logs, User Activity	Medium	High	High	Logging, Monitoring & Incident Response Policy	ICT Admin	Open
M365-R8	Physical/ Operational	Unauthorized physical access to shared devices or exam labs resulting in data exposure or system misuse	Shared PCs, Exam Labs	Academic Records, Exams	Low	Medium	Medium	Physical & Environmental Security Policy	Operations	Open
M365-R9	Resilience/ Availability	Loss of academic data or prolonged service disruption due to inadequate backup or recovery processes	OneDrive, SharePoint, Teams	Academic Records, Learning Materials	Low	High	Medium	Backup, Recovery & Business Continuity Policy	ICT Admin	Open



M365-R10	Third-Party/Supply Chain	Vendor or Third-party access to M365 introduces security or data privacy risks	M365 Tenant	Student & Institutional Data	Low	High	Medium	Third-Party & Vendor Access Policy	Compliance Officer	Open
M365-R11	Governance / Change	Uncontrolled M365 feature changes or AI feature enablement introduce security or compliance risks	M365 Tenant, Copilot	All Data Types	Medium	Medium	Medium	Change Management Policy	ICT Admin	Open
M365-R12	Ethical/ Academic Integrity	Misuse of AI and Copilot tools leading to plagiarism, bias, or exposure of sensitive data	Copilot, Office Online	Academic Content, Student Data	Medium	Medium	Medium	AI& Copilot use Policy	Faculty	Open
M365-R13	Compliance / Awareness	Lack of user awareness or inconsistent enforcement leads to	All M365 Services	All Data Types	Medium	Medium	Medium	Compliance, Enforcement & Awareness Policy	Compliance Officer	Open



		repeated policy violations								
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